



▲ CAVALRY TROOPER'S SWORD PATTERN 1853

Date 1853

Origin UK

Weight 1.13kg (2½lb)

Length 1m (3½ft)

Of fairly conventional construction, the 1853 Pattern cavalry trooper's sword equipped British heavy cavalry in the Crimean War and during some of Britain's subsequent colonial campaigns.

Single-edged blade

▲ INFANTRY SWORD MODEL 1850

Date c.1850

Origin US

Weight 1.13kg (2½lb)

Length 76.8cm (30¼in)

In the American Civil War, edged weapons such as this Model 1850 equipped most infantry officers on the Union side. Its single-edged blade is slightly curved, and the leather grip is wrapped in twisted brass wire.



▲ LIGHT CAVALRY SABRE MODEL 1860

Date c.1860

Origin US

Weight 1.36kg (3lb)

Length 90cm (35in)

The Model 1860 Light cavalry sabre was an effective thrusting and hacking weapon for the cavalry in the American Civil War. It was a lighter version of the 1840 sabre.

Single-edged blade with short, sharpened section on back edge of blade

Curved, single-edged blade



◀ MLE 1866 CHASSEPOT BAYONET

Date 1866

Origin France

Weight 760g (27¼oz)

Length 70cm (27½in)

This bayonet is from the Chassepot breech-loading rifle that armed the French during the Franco-Prussian War of 1870–71. The recurved yataghan-style blade influenced many European and American designs.

Serrated edge for sawing wood

Conventional bayonet blade



▲ PATTERN 1869 TRIALS BAYONET

Date 1869

Origin UK

Weight 640g (22½oz)

Length 64.2cm (25in)

The Elcho bayonets, with their broad blade end, were considered too ungainly, and were not taken up as an official model. This earlier design with a narrower blade had also failed to impress the authorities.

Serrated edge for sawing wood



▼ PATTERN 1871 ELCHO BAYONET

Date 1871

Origin UK

Weight 650g (23oz)

Length 64cm (25in)

Lord Elcho designed this bayonet to go with the Martini-Henry rifle. Elcho extended the bayonet's range of tasks to include those of hacking down brush and sawing wood.

Locking bolt spring

Broad end of blade for chopping purposes

